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COURSE:OPERATING SYSTEMS

Q1) Deadlock bugging

Problem Identification

The deadlock occurs because:

P1 locks R1 and waits for R2.

P2 locks R2 and waits for R1.

Each process holds one resource while waiting for the other.

Neither process releases its resource, causing an infinite wait.

This is a circular wait, one of the four necessary conditions for deadlock.

EXECUTION SEQUENCE:

P1 locks R1 successfully.

P2 locks R2 successfully.

P1 requests R2 but waits because P2 holds it.

P2 requests R1 but waits because P1 holds it.

Both processes wait for each other indefinitely, resulting in a deadlock.

OPTIMIZATION:

Use resource ordering.

Both processes should acquire resources in the same order.

Process P1

lock(R1)

lock(R2)

Critical Section

unlock(R2)

unlock(R1)

Process P2

lock(R1)

lock(R2)

Critical Section

unlock(R2)

unlock(R1)

ANALYSIS: Since every process requests resources in the same order, circular waiting is removed and deadlock cannot occur.

Q2) CPU Utilization Problem

Problem Identification:

CPU utilization is only 30% because processes frequently move:

Ready → Waiting → Ready → Waiting

This indicates the processes are I/O-bound rather than CPU-bound.

The CPU remains idle while waiting for I/O operations.

DEBUGGING:

Frequent waiting states suggest:

Continuous disk/network access

Short CPU bursts

High I/O waiting time

As a result:

CPU executes briefly.

Process waits for I/O.

CPU becomes idle.

OPTIMIZATION:

Use asynchronous I/O

CPU continues executing other tasks while I/O completes.

Increase multiprogramming

Schedule another ready process whenever one enters waiting state.

ANALYSIS: Better scheduling ensures another process uses the CPU instead of leaving it idle, increasing CPU utilization.

Q3) Memory Bottleneck Debugging

Problem Identification:

Memory usage:

Code = 5 MB

Heap = 150 MB

Stack = 1 MB × 25 = 25 MB

Total memory used:

5 + 150 + 25 = 180 MB

Although RAM is 2 GB, the large heap and many threads can cause poor memory locality.
Frequent page faults occur because memory pages are repeatedly swapped between RAM and storage.

DEBUGGING:

Main issue:

- Large heap accesses
- Multiple thread stacks
- Poor cache locality
- Increased page faults
- Optimization

Optimization 1

Reduce heap usage by releasing unused memory.

Optimization 2

Reduce the number of threads or use a thread pool.

ANALYSIS: Smaller memory usage reduces page faults and improves execution speed.

Q4) Starvation Debugging

Problem Identification

Queue structure:

Q1 → Interactive

Q2 → System

Q3 → Batch (P5)

Scheduler always serves higher-priority queues first.

If Q1 and Q2 continuously receive processes, P5 in Q3 never executes.

This is starvation.

DEBUGGING

Execution:

Q1 arrives

↓

CPU executes Q1

More Q1 arrives

↓

Q2 arrives

↓

P5 remains waiting

↓

Infinite postponement

OPTIMIZATION:

Use Aging and increase the priority of P5 gradually as its waiting time increases.

Example:

After every 20 ms waiting

Priority++

Eventually

Q3 → Q2 → Q1

ANALYSIS: Aging guarantees every process eventually receives CPU time and prevents starvation.

Q5) Context-Switch Overhead Debugging

Problem Identification:

Given:

Context switches = 20,000/sec

Burst time = 2 ms

Time quantum = 1 ms

Very frequent I/O

Since quantum (1 ms) is smaller than burst time (2 ms), each thread is preempted before finishing.

Frequent I/O also causes additional context switches.

DEBUGGING:

Flow:

Run 1 ms

↓

Quantum expires

↓

Context Switch

↓

Another thread

↓

I/O wait

↓

Context Switch

Thousands of switches occur every second.

OPTIMIZATION:

Optimization 1:

Increase time quantum.

Example:

1 ms → 4 ms

Threads complete before preemption.

Optimization 2

Reduce unnecessary I/O waits by using:

I/O buffering

Asynchronous I/O

ANALYSIS: A larger time quantum reduces scheduler interruptions, while optimized I/O lowers waiting-related context switches, significantly improving system performance.